within the system are international actors who fall within the sub-class, “national actor”. ‘Essential’ being used as an undefined term, the number of essential actors must be at least five and preferably more.

Morgenthau in his *Politics Among Nations: The Struggle for Power and Peace* has given four meanings of the term:

1. A policy aimed at a certain state of affairs
2. An actual state of affairs
3. An approximately equal distribution of power
4. Any distribution of power.

Haas[6] has given eight mutually exclusive versions of the concept of balance of power:

1. Equilibrium resulting from equal distribution of power among nation-states.
2. Equilibrium resulting from unequal distribution of power among nation-states.
3. Equilibrium resulting from the dominance of one nation-state (the balancer).
4. A system providing for relative stability and peace.
5. A system characterized by instability and war.
6. Another way of saying power politics.
7. A universal law of history.
8. A guide for policy makers.

Kenneth Waltz*[7] in his *Theory of International Politics* (1979) does not assume that states are self-aggrandizing and aggressive bodies but he does assume that they have a necessity to preserve themselves. Thus, they are obliged to be concerned with their security and take into considerations the existence of other states, posing to be potential threats. This induces the states to continually adjust their stance in international relations according to their reading of power of other states and their own power. The result of these movements is the emergence of the balance of power.

Hedley Bull‡[8] in his *The Anarchical Society* (1977) considers the balance of power as a kind of artefact, something that states, or a